NVC

Help

Version 2.3.0

Language: en

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Introduction

NVC is a Windows video converter built around FFmpeg. It watches a source folder, converts supported media, inspects media information, records up to four sources, plays media side by side, generates a PC report, and can clean up original files after conversion.

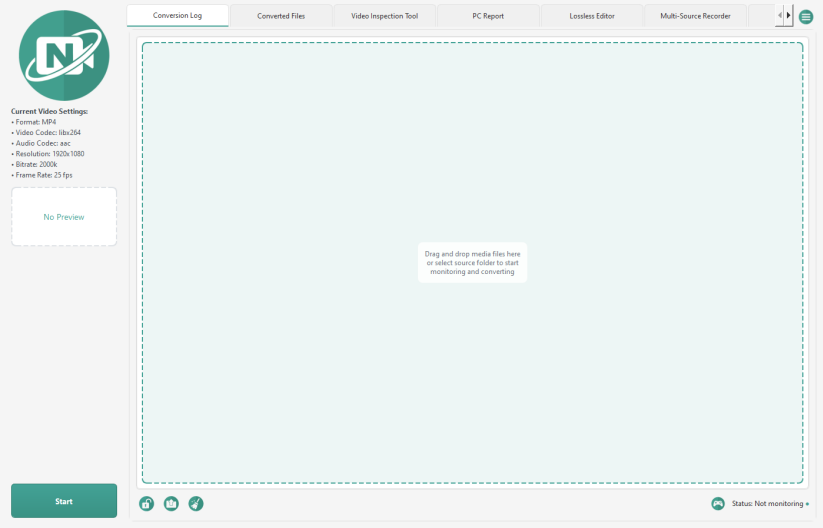


Figure 0. The NVC main window, with the conversion log and preview panel.

Note

- Overwrite policy: NVC never overwrites an already converted video. If the destination already contains video.mp4, the next output becomes video (1).mp4, then video (2).mp4 -- the same style web browsers use for duplicate downloads.

Quick Start

Six steps from a fresh install to a converted file.

1. Open Settings from the menu.
2. On the Folders tab, choose the Source Folder.
3. On the Folders tab, choose the Destination Folder.
4. On the Format tab, choose the Output Format, Video Codec and Audio Codec. The defaults suit most cases.
5. Click OK, and then click Start.
6. Drop videos into the source folder.

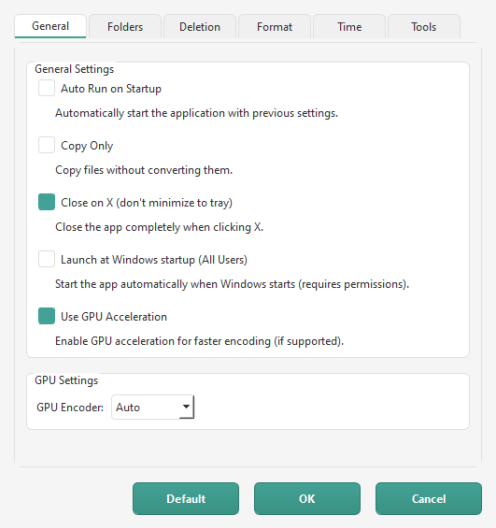


Figure 1. Settings, General tab: startup, Copy Only, tray and GPU options.

Main Window Overview

The main window is organised into tabs, with a shared preview panel and a status footer.

Area	What it does
Conversion Log	Shows conversion messages, progress, warnings and results.
Converted Files	Lists queued, processing, successful and failed conversions.
Video Inspection Tool	Shows a summary and detailed media information for a selected file.
PC Report	Generates a PC report for support and troubleshooting.
Lossless Editor	Provides trim, remux, merge and audio stream-copy tools.
Multi-Source Recorder	Records up to four video sources.
Media Player	Plays media in one, two or four panels.
Preview Panel	Shows a preview of the current file or recorder layout.
Menu	Opens Info, Help, folders, Settings, Language, updates and Quit.

Note

- PC Report, Lossless Editor and Media Player are hidden by default. Turn them on in Settings -- Tools. Play in Media Player shows the Media Player tab for the current session even when it is switched off.
- The Menu contains Info, Help, Open Source Folder, Open Destination Folder, Open Backup Folder, Settings, Language, Check for Updates and Quit.
- The footer has the Start/Stop button, a lock icon, a file picker, a broom and a status label. On the recorder tab the button reads Start Recording or Stop Recording. The lock icon locks settings, and the Start button then reads Locked. The file picker selects media files to convert, and the broom clears the log.
- Clicking X closes NVC by default. Clear "Close on X (don't minimize to tray)" in Settings -- General to minimise to the system tray instead. The tray menu has Show and Quit. Only one copy of NVC can run at a time.

Converting Files

When monitoring is active, NVC watches the source folder for new supported videos. It also scans existing files in that folder when monitoring starts.

You can drag files onto Conversion Log, Converted Files or Video Inspection Tool. You can also use the file picker in the footer to select media files to convert.

NVC protects existing converted files. If a converted output name already exists, NVC chooses the next available browser-style filename:

```
Session.mp4
Session (1).mp4
Session (2).mp4
```

NVC accepts common video formats including MP4, AVI, WMV, MKV, FLV, WebM, MOV, MPEG, MPG, M4V, 3GP, TS, VOB, RM, RMVB, ASF, M2TS, MTS, OGV, DIVX, DV and F4V.

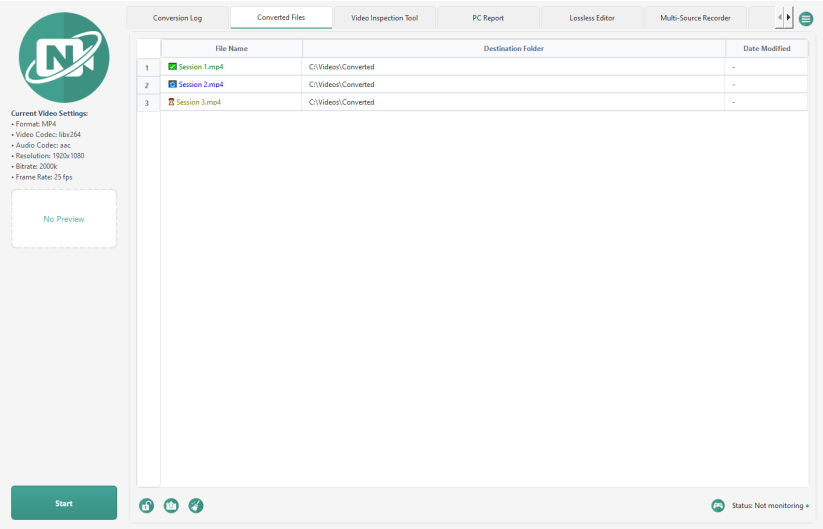


Figure 3. The Converted Files tab tracking queued and finished jobs.

Conversion Settings

Settings has six tabs: General, Folders, Deletion, Format, Time and Tools. Default restores every value, OK saves, and Cancel discards changes.

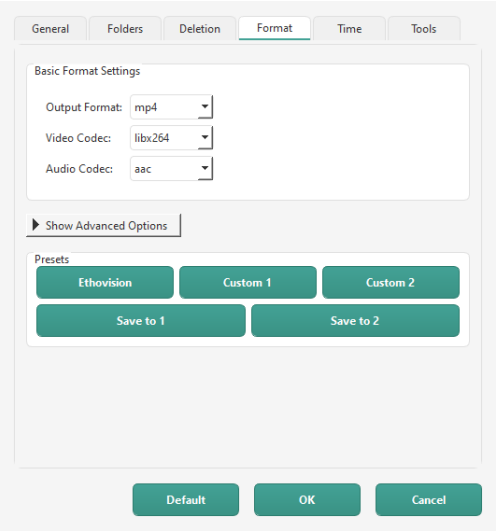


Figure 2. Settings, Format tab: output format, codec and bitrate.

The General tab controls application behaviour and GPU encoding.

Setting	Guidance
Auto Run on Startup	Starts monitoring automatically with the previous settings.
Copy Only	Remuxes the source streams into the selected Output Format without re-encoding (FFmpeg -c copy), which is fast but fails when the container cannot hold the source streams. The Lossless Editor's Remux does the same for single files.
Close on X (don't minimize to tray)	Ticked by default. Clear it to minimise NVC to the system tray when you click X.
Launch at Windows startup (All Users)	Launches NVC when Windows starts for all users and requires permission.
Use GPU Acceleration	Enables GPU acceleration when supported.
GPU Encoder	Choose Auto, nvidia, intel or amd.

The Folders tab selects the folders used by NVC.

Setting	Guidance
Source Folder	Click Change to select the folder NVC watches and scans.
Destination Folder	Click Change to select where converted files are written.
Backup Folder	Click Change to select where backed-up originals are moved.
Log Folder	Shows the log location. NVC currently always writes logs to %APPDATA%\NVC\logs; changing this field has no effect in this version.

The Deletion tab controls original files. See the Original File Handling chapter.

The Format tab controls the conversion output.

Setting	Guidance
Output Format	Choose mp4, mov, avi, mkv, flv, webm, mpeg, mpg, 3gp, ogg, wmv, m4v, mp3 or gif.
Video Codec	Choose libx264, mpeg4, libvpx, hevc, flv, libtheora or wmv2.
Audio Codec	Choose aac, mp3, ac3, opus or vorbis.
GIF options	FPS, Max Width, Loop and Quick GIF (no palette) appear when Output Format is gif.
Show Advanced Options	Shows Video Size, Bitrate, Frame Rate, Keyframe Interval (GOP), Volume, Text Overlay and Console Integration.
Video Size	Choose Auto, 640x480, 1280x720, 1920x1080 or 3840x2160.
Bitrate	Choose Auto or a listed value from 512k to 3000k.
Frame Rate	Choose Auto or a listed rate from 8 to 60.
Keyframe Interval (GOP)	Choose 0 for Auto or a value up to 300.
Volume	Set output audio volume from 0 to 500 %.
Text Overlay	Adds text to the output. See the Text Overlays chapter.
Console Integration	Appends custom FFmpeg flags to the command.
Presets	Use Ethovision, Custom 1, Custom 2, Save to 1 or Save to 2.

The Time tab limits when conversion may start.

Setting	Guidance
No Time Restrictions	Allows conversion at any time.
Start Time	Sets the start of the allowed conversion window.
End Time	Sets the end of the allowed conversion window. See Time Restrictions.

The Tools tab controls which tool tabs appear in the main window.

Setting	Guidance
Tool checkboxes	There is one checkbox for each tool tab. Unticked tabs are hidden from the main window.

GPU Encoding

If enabled, NVC attempts to use a supported GPU encoder for NVIDIA, AMD or Intel hardware. GPU encoding can be much faster than CPU encoding, but the available codecs depend on your installed GPU drivers and FFmpeg build.

```
H.264 GPU encoders:  h264_nvenc   h264_amf   h264_qsv
HEVC  GPU encoders:  hevc_nvenc   hevc_amf   hevc_qsv
```

Note

- If the selected GPU encoder is unavailable, NVC falls back to CPU encoding where possible.
- Detection runs once per session and is cached. If you install new GPU drivers, restart NVC so it re-detects the available encoders.

GIF Export

GIF output can use a two-pass palette workflow for better colour quality. You can adjust FPS, Max Width and Loop, or select Quick GIF (no palette). A lower FPS and a smaller Max Width both reduce file size.

Note

- GIF files grow quickly. For long clips, convert to MP4 instead.

Text Overlays

Text Overlay burns the selected text into the output video.

Overlay	Shows
None	No overlay.
Elapsed Time	The elapsed playback time.
Recorded Time	The recorded time of day.
Recorded Date/Time	The recorded date and time.
Recorded Date/Time + Remaining	The recorded date and time on one line and remaining seconds on another.
CRTV Cam	A blinking REC label and the recorded time.

Note

- Overlays require video filtering and may reduce GPU compatibility and conversion speed.
- Recorded overlays use the file's recorded time when present and otherwise use the file modified time.

Original File Handling

Option	Behaviour
Delete files after conversion	Deletes the original after a successful conversion, immediately when retention is 0 or after the retention period.
Retention time (days)	Choose 0 to 30 days. Pending deletions are stored on disk and processed after a restart.
Use Backup Folder	Moves originals to the Backup Folder instead of deleting them.

Note

- Keep originals until you have confirmed the converted files play correctly.

Time Restrictions

Settings -- Time lets you select No Time Restrictions or set a Start Time and End Time for conversion.

Note

- A file detected outside the window is skipped with "Current time outside allowed range" in the Conversion Log. It is not queued for later. Drop the file again, or let monitoring re-detect it, inside the permitted window.
- An End Time earlier than the Start Time means an overnight window.
- The default is No Time Restrictions.

Converted Files

Converted Files has File Name, Destination Folder and Date Modified columns. Status icons identify queued, processing, successful and failed conversions.

Control	What it does
Play	Opens the selected file in the Media Player tab.
Clear	Clears the Converted Files table.
Play in Media Player	Opens the selected file in the Media Player tab.
Open Containing Folder	Opens the selected file's destination folder.
Open Log File	Opens a dialog containing the per-file conversion log.
Copy File Path	Copies the selected file path.
Settings	Opens Settings.

Media Inspection

The Video Inspection Tool tab has Summary and Detailed JSON sub-tabs. Drop a file on either sub-tab to populate both. Summary lists File, Container, Duration, Size, Bitrate and Number of Streams. It then lists each video, audio and subtitle stream, including its codec and the applicable resolution, frame rate or channels. A Keyframe Analysis (First 30s) block follows the stream details. Detailed JSON shows the raw ffprobe -print_format json output.

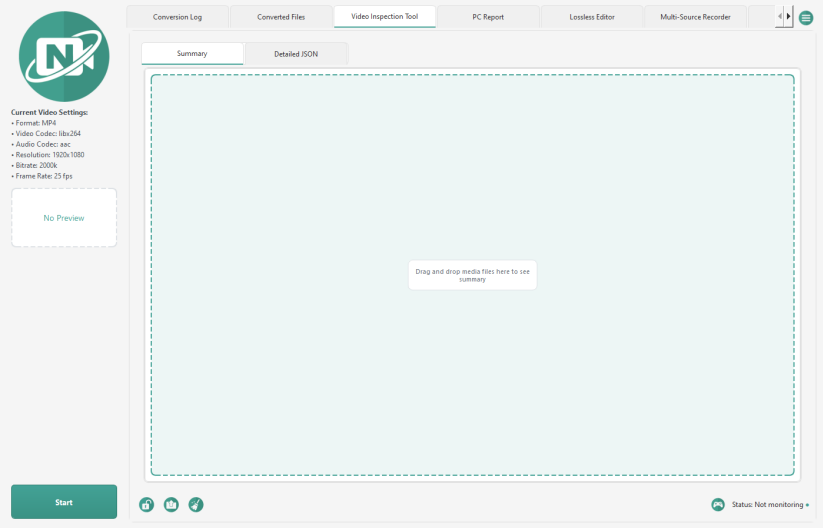


Figure 4. The Video Inspection Tool tab, ready for a file to be dropped.

PC Report Tool

The PC Report tool gathers system information for support and troubleshooting.

1. Click Generate PC Report.
2. Wait for collection to finish. Some collectors can take a while.
3. Click Open Report to open the generated HTML. Open Folder opens whichever folder the report was written to.
4. Reports are saved to your Desktop by default, with the path pattern Desktop\PC_Report_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS.html. If there is no Desktop folder, NVC uses your user profile folder instead. If that file name already exists, NVC chooses a unique name and never overwrites the existing file.

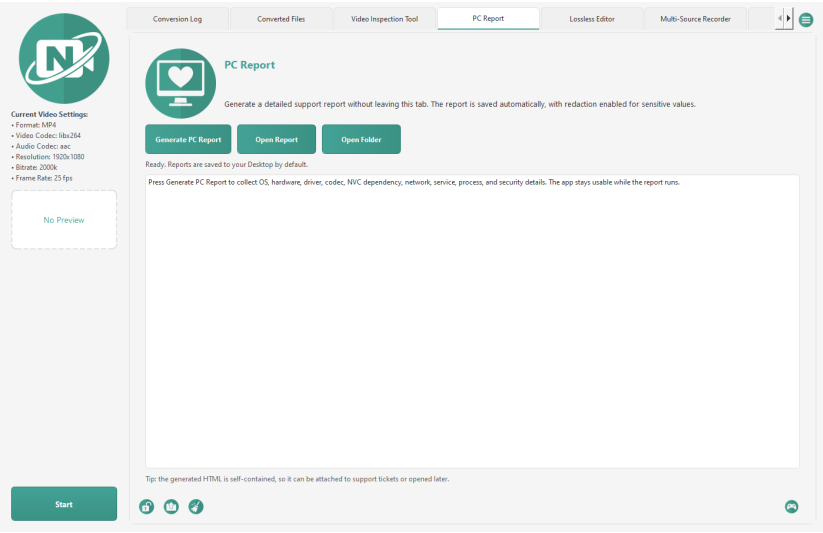


Figure 5. The PC Report tab before a report is generated.

The report opens with Report Health (timing, empty sections and warnings) and then these sections:

```
Noldus Summary
Operating System
Installed Updates
Licenses
System Directories
System Files
Installed Programs
Security
Accessibility
Environment
Regional Settings
Processes
Services
Drivers
Autorun
Codecs
MMC Snap-ins
System Summary
Motherboard
BIOS
CPU
Memory
Sensors
Devices
PCI
System Slots
Network Adapters
Video
Monitors
Sound
Storage Devices
Logical Disks
Ports
USB
Printers
Virtual Machine
Cameras
Network Information
Shares
Network Connections
```

Note

- Redaction is always on. NVC masks serial numbers, licence keys, passwords and tokens, user and machine names, hostnames, IP and MAC addresses, proxy settings, UNC paths and user profile paths. Review a report before sharing it anyway.
- Some values need administrator rights and show "Requires administrator" when NVC runs normally. Right-click NVC and choose Run as administrator for a complete report.
- Drivers, devices, network connections and processes are the slow collectors on large systems.

Lossless Editor

The Lossless Editor tab provides FFmpeg stream-copy tools. These operations are fast because they avoid re-encoding wherever possible. Output container choices are mp4, mkv, mov, avi and m4a; Extract Audio always uses m4a.

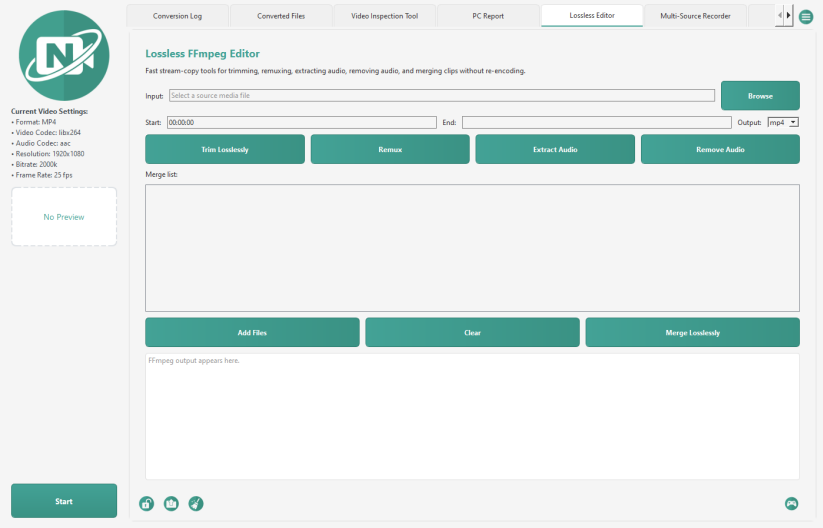


Figure 6. The Lossless Editor tab with its trim, remux and merge tools.

Operation	What it does
Trim Losslessly	Cuts a section between start and end timestamps using stream copy.
Remux	Rewraps media into mp4, mkv, mov or avi without re-encoding.
Extract Audio	Writes the first audio stream to an audio-only m4a file.
Remove Audio	Writes a silent, video-only copy.
Merge Losslessly	Joins compatible clips using the FFmpeg concat demuxer.
Add Files	Adds source clips to the merge list.
Clear	Removes every source clip from the merge list.

Note

- Lossless operations need compatible codecs and containers. If FFmpeg fails, the source streams may need re-encoding, or a different output container.
- A lossless trim can only cut on a keyframe, so the actual start may shift slightly earlier than the timestamp you enter.

Multi-Source Recorder

The Multi-Source Recorder records up to four sources at once with FFmpeg. The tab shows one row per source; configure the sources in the Video Settings dialog.

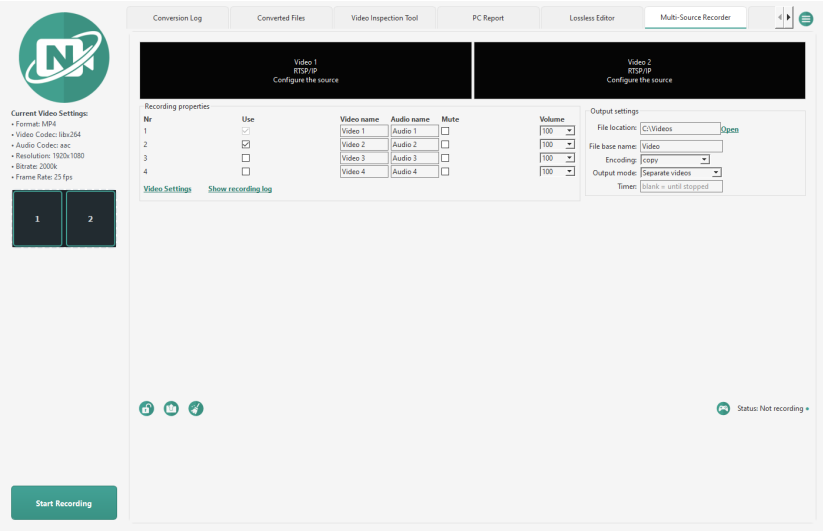


Figure 7. The Multi-Source Recorder tab with two sources enabled.

The recorder tab

Control	What it does
Use	Records this row.
Video name	Sets the label used in the file name.
Audio name	Sets the audio label for the row.
Mute	Records the row without sound.
Volume	Sets the audio level to 100, 75, 50, 25 or 0 %.
Encoding	copy keeps the source's own compressed video only for RTSP, stream and file sources. USB (DirectShow) cameras are always re-encoded with H.264 regardless of the Encoding choice.
Output mode	Separate videos writes one file per row; Combined grid writes one file with all sources tiled.
File location	Sets the recording folder. The default is your Videos folder.
File base name	The default is Video. Separate videos, and Combined grid with one enabled source, use <base>_<Video name>_<timestamp>.mp4. Combined grid with more than one enabled source uses <base>_Combined_<timestamp>.mp4.
Timer	The field shows "blank = until stopped"; leave it blank to record until you press Stop Recording.
Show recording log	Opens the recording log.
Start Recording / Stop Recording	The footer button starts or stops recording.

Video Settings

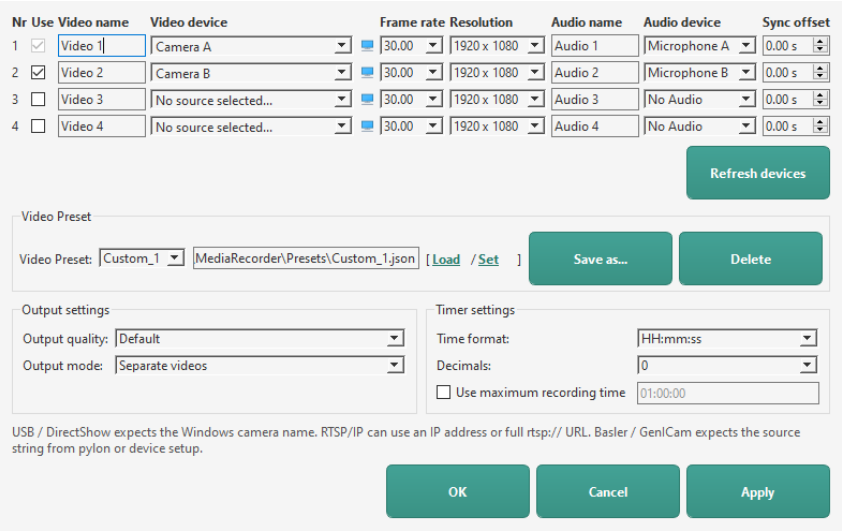


Figure 9. The recorder's Video Settings dialog with two camera rows configured.

1. Open Video Settings. Each row has Use, Video name, Video device, a camera settings button, Frame rate, Resolution, Audio name, Audio device and Sync offset.
2. In Video device choose a USB camera by its Windows name, choose RTSP/IP Camera and click the camera button to enter Address / URL, Username, Password, Port and Stream path, or type an rtsp://, http:// or https:// URL, a file path, or a Basler / GenICam source string directly. Refresh USB devices... rescans.
3. The default Frame rate list is 30.00, 25.00 and 15.00; the default Resolution list is 1920 x 1080, 1280 x 720, 640 x 480 and Auto. When a USB camera is selected, NVC replaces both lists with the modes the driver reports and adds Auto to each. If detection fails, the lists are left as they were: leave Resolution at Auto and choose a frame rate the camera supports. Auto is only offered for Frame rate after successful detection.
4. Choose an Audio device per row, or No Audio. Refresh devices rescans microphones. Mute or Volume 0 on the tab records that row without sound.
5. Sync offset shifts a source earlier or later in a Combined grid recording so clips that started at slightly different times line up.
6. Apply keeps the dialog open; OK applies and closes.

Presets

1. Load applies the selected preset; Set overwrites it with the current settings; Save as... creates a new one; Delete removes it. An asterisk after the name marks unsaved changes.
2. Presets are JSON files under Public\Documents\Noldus\NVC\MediaRecorder\Presets.

Note

- Without a microphone, a file or RTSP source in h264 mode keeps its own sound track; in copy mode an RTSP source is recorded without audio; a USB camera without a microphone is silent. Combined grid takes its audio from the first enabled, unmuted row with a microphone.
- A saved microphone that is not connected shows as (not found). If the audio device fails as recording starts, NVC restarts that row as video only and says so in the recording log, so the camera recording is not lost.
- FFmpeg needs the exact Windows camera name; close other applications that may be using the camera.

Media Player

The Media Player loads up to four clips for synchronized review. The tab is hidden by default; enable it under Settings -> Tools. Play in Media Player from Converted Files shows the tab for the current session, loads the selected file and starts playback.

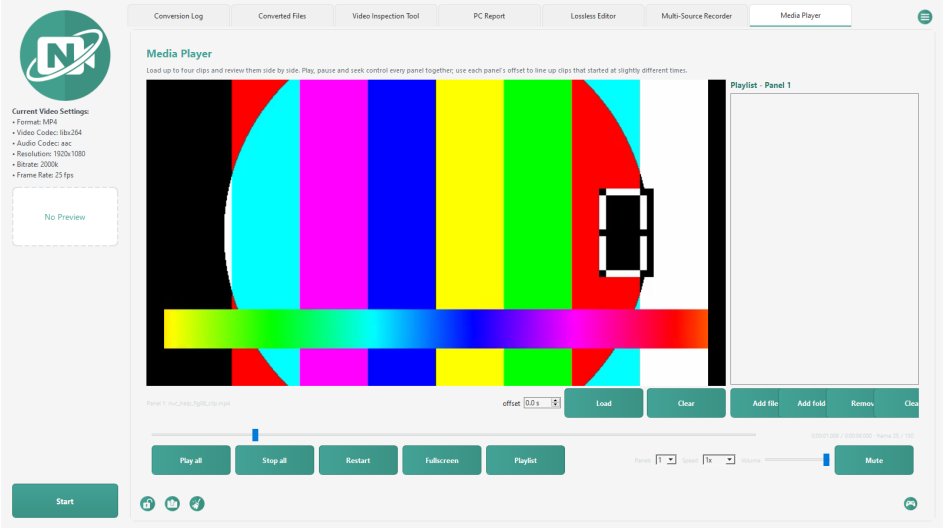


Figure 8. The Media Player tab with a clip loaded in a single panel.

Control	What it does
Load	Loads a clip into that panel.
Clear	Removes the clip from that panel.
offset	Shifts that panel in seconds relative to the shared seek position.
Play all	Plays every visible loaded panel and reads Pause all while playing.
Stop all	Stops every loaded panel and returns the shared position to zero.
Restart	Returns to the beginning and plays every visible loaded panel.
Seek slider	Moves every visible loaded panel on the shared timeline.
Speed	Sets every panel to 0.25x, 0.5x, 1x, 1.5x or 2x playback.
Panels	Shows 1, 2 or 4 panels.
Volume	Sets the volume for every panel from 0 to 100.
Mute	Mutes every panel and reads Unmute while muted.
Fullscreen	Shows the panels and transport bar fullscreen.
Playlist	Shows or hides the playlist for the selected panel.

The readout shows H:MM:SS.mmm / H:MM:SS.mmm · frame N / M. NVC reads the clip's real frame rate with FFprobe, so Left and Right step exactly one frame. Frame stepping pauses playback.

Keys	Action
Space	Play or pause

Home	Restart from the beginning
Left	Step back one frame
Right	Step forward one frame
Shift+Left	Seek back 5 seconds
Shift+Right	Seek forward 5 seconds
Up	Volume up 5
Down	Volume down 5
M	Mute or unmute
F	Toggle fullscreen
Escape	Leave fullscreen
N	Next playlist item
P	Previous playlist item

Shortcuts work while the Media Player tab has focus. Press F, click Fullscreen, or double-click a panel to enter fullscreen. The transport bar hides three seconds after the mouse stops moving and returns when the mouse moves. Press Escape or F, or double-click, to leave fullscreen.

Playlist opens a dock for the selected panel with Add files..., Add folder..., Remove and Clear. Drag entries to reorder them, or drop files from Explorer into the dock. N and P move through the playlist. With Panels set to 1, the next item starts automatically when a clip ends.

Note

- A file Windows cannot decode shows "Windows cannot play this file." or names the codec and container, with "Convert to MP4 (H.264) and play". The converted copy is written to your Destination Folder with a unique name and then loaded.
- NVC remembers the last folder, panel count, volume and mute between sessions.
- Playback uses Windows Media Foundation. MP4, MOV, MKV, AVI and WMV files with common codecs play directly; use the convert offer for anything else.

Language

Menu -- Language lists English, Nederlands and Simplified Chinese; the last entry appears in the menu in Chinese characters. NVC saves the choice and says "NVC will show <language> the next time it starts." The manuals are in English.

Updates and Logs

Item	Where / what
Check for Updates	Open it from the menu. A build without an update address answers "Updates Not Configured". When an address is configured and a newer version exists, "Update v<version> Available!" appears in the sidebar.
Log file	All logs are under %APPDATA%\NVC\logs. The rotating application log is conversion_log.txt, and each conversion has an <output file name>.txt log.
NVC_LOG_LEVEL	Set this environment variable to DEBUG to record full tracebacks.
Settings file	%APPDATA%\NVC\config.json.
Default media folders	Public\Documents\Noldus\NVC\Source, Public\Documents\Noldus\NVC\Destination and Public\Documents\Noldus\NVC\Backup.
Recorder presets	Public\Documents\Noldus\NVC\MediaRecorder\Presets.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to try
Missing FFmpeg or FFprobe	Make sure ffmpeg.exe and ffprobe.exe are present alongside the app files.
Conversion fails immediately	Check the conversion log. Invalid codec and container combinations, and custom FFmpeg flags, are the common causes.
Output file already exists	NVC creates a numbered filename automatically. Check the destination folder for (1), (2), and so on.
GPU option does not work	Update your GPU drivers, confirm FFmpeg supports your encoder, or disable GPU encoding to fall back to the CPU.
App appears idle after dropping a file	Confirm the app is unlocked, monitoring is started, and the file extension is supported.
PC report is slow	Drivers, devices, network connections and processes are the slow collectors on large systems. Let them finish.
Camera: Could not find video device	FFmpeg needs the exact Windows camera name. Pick it from the Video device list rather than typing it, and close other applications that may hold the camera.
Microphone shows (not found)	The saved microphone is not connected. Plug it in and click Refresh devices, or choose another device or No Audio.
Recording has no sound	Check Mute and Volume on the tab and the Audio device in Video Settings. If the audio device failed at start, NVC recorded video only and says so in the recording log.
Media Player says Windows cannot play this file	The codec or container is not supported by Windows Media Foundation. Click Convert to MP4 (H.264) and play.
A tool tab is missing	Open Settings, Tools tab, and tick it.
Help menu says the document was not found	The generated manual must sit in docs/help, a help folder, or next to the executable. Rebuild it with python docs/help/source/build_help_docs.py.
Something failed with no message	Set the NVC_LOG_LEVEL environment variable to DEBUG and reproduce the problem. NVC then records the full traceback for errors it would otherwise handle quietly.

NVC stores logs under %APPDATA%\NVC\logs: conversion_log.txt is the rotating application log, and each conversion has an <output file name>.txt log that Converted Files -- Open Log File opens.

Best Practices

1. Use a dedicated source folder and destination folder.
2. Keep originals until you have confirmed the converted files play correctly.
3. Use MP4 with H.264 and AAC for the broadest compatibility.
4. Use HEVC only when smaller files matter and the target players support it.
5. Review PC reports before sharing them.
6. Keep custom FFmpeg flags simple, and test them on a small file first.
7. Save a recorder preset for each camera setup so a session starts with one Load.
8. Review recordings with Panels set to 1 when you want the playlist to advance automatically.

Frequently Asked Questions

Question	Answer
Will NVC overwrite my converted videos?	No. NVC creates a numbered filename when an output already exists.
Can I convert files while monitoring is stopped?	Dropped files may be queued and processed when monitoring starts, depending on where they are dropped. Files can also be force-converted through the drag-and-drop paths meant for manual conversion.
Why did my HEVC file fail to play somewhere?	HEVC is efficient but less universally supported than H.264. If compatibility matters, use H.264.
Where are logs stored?	Every log is under %APPDATA%\NVC\logs: conversion_log.txt is the rotating application log, with one <output file name>.txt log per conversion.
Can I run two copies of NVC at once?	No. NVC allows a single instance, so two copies cannot process the same source folder.
Where do recordings go?	The File location on the recorder tab, your Videos folder by default, named <base>_<Video name>_<timestamp>.mp4 or <base>_Combined_<timestamp>.mp4.
Why does my MKV not play in the Media Player?	Windows Media Foundation does not decode every codec. Use Convert to MP4 (H.264) and play; the copy goes to your Destination Folder.
Can I record without a microphone?	Yes. Choose No Audio, or Mute the row. A file or RTSP source in h264 mode keeps its own sound track.
Why does the PC report say Requires administrator?	Some Windows data is only readable elevated. Run NVC as administrator for a complete report; redaction still applies.

Glossary

Terms used throughout this guide. FFmpeg terminology is kept where it is what you will see in the conversion log.

Term	Meaning
Container	The file wrapper that holds video and audio streams, such as MP4, MKV or AVI. The container is what the file extension names; it is separate from the codec used inside it.
Codec	The scheme used to compress a stream. H.264 (libx264) and HEVC (libx265) are video codecs; AAC and MP3 are audio codecs.
FFmpeg	The command-line media tool NVC runs to do the actual conversion. Its output is what appears in the conversion log.
FFprobe	FFmpeg's inspection tool. NVC uses it to read duration, streams, codecs and other metadata without converting anything.
Stream copy	Rewriting media into a new container without re-encoding it. Fast and lossless, but only possible when the target container supports the existing streams. Also called remuxing.
Remux	Changing a file's container while keeping its streams untouched. See stream copy.
Transcode	Decoding and re-encoding a stream, which changes quality and takes significantly longer than a stream copy.
Keyframe	A frame stored in full rather than as a difference from its neighbours. Seeking and lossless trimming can only land cleanly on a keyframe.
GOP	Group of Pictures: the interval between keyframes. A shorter GOP makes scrubbing more precise at the cost of file size.
Bitrate	Data used per second of media, usually in kbps or Mbps. Higher bitrate generally means better quality and a larger file.
GPU encoding	Using dedicated video hardware (NVENC on NVIDIA, AMF on AMD, Quick Sync on Intel) to encode instead of the CPU. Much faster, with codec support depending on your drivers.
DirectShow	The Windows capture interface NVC uses to record from local devices. Sources are written as video=Device Name.
Media Foundation	The Windows playback framework the Media Player uses to decode and play supported media.
RTSP	A streaming protocol used by most IP and network cameras. Sources are written as a URL, such as rtsp://192.168.1.10/stream.
GenICam	The generic camera interface used by Basler and other industrial cameras. Configure these cameras in Basler pylon Viewer.
Preset	A saved recorder configuration stored as JSON under Public\Documents\Noldus\NVC\MediaRecorder\Presets.
Sync offset	A time adjustment that shifts one source earlier or later in a Combined grid recording so sources line up.

Frame step	Moving exactly one frame forward or backward using the clip's frame rate.
Playlist	An ordered list of media files for one Media Player panel. With one panel, the next item starts automatically.
Administrator (elevation)	Running NVC with administrator rights so the PC report can read protected Windows data.
Tool tab	A main-window tab that can be hidden or shown in Settings -- Tools.
Retention period	How long NVC keeps an original file after a successful conversion before deleting it. Pending deletions survive a restart.
Redaction	Always-on masking of sensitive values such as licence keys, serial numbers, MAC addresses and user paths in a PC report before it is shared.